

Pradhan Mantri Janjatiya Vikas Mission



Source: PIB

Why in News?

The Government has highlighted the role of the **Pradhan Mantri Janjatiya Vikas Mission** in strengthening India's tribal forest economy by organising tribal communities into **Van Dhan Vikas Kendras** and helping them move from raw produce sellers to value-adding entrepreneurs.

What Are the Key Features of Pradhan Mantri Janjatiya Vikas Mission (PMJVM)?

- **About:** PMJVM is a Central Sector Scheme of the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, created by merging the MSP for MFP and Development of Value Chain for MFP scheme with the Institutional Support for Development and Marketing of Tribal Products/Produce scheme.
- **Objective:** It aims to promote **tribal livelihoods and entrepreneurship** through production, procurement, processing, value addition and marketing of tribal produce, supported by backward and forward linkages.
- **Nodal Agency:** **TRIFED (Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India)** is the central implementing agency, working directly or through State Implementing Agencies.
- **Major Components:** The scheme supports **MSP-based procurement of Minor Forest Produce (MFP)**, **Van Dhan Vikas Kendras (VDVKs)**, **Van Dhan Producer Enterprises (VDPEs)**, **value addition, skill development, branding, e-commerce and marketing infrastructure**.
- **Financial Support:** Up to **₹15 lakh** can be provided for setting up a VDVK, while a VDPE can receive up to **₹64 lakh over three years** for enterprise development and capacity building.
- **Special Focus:** **Aspirational Districts, Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) and Forest Rights Act land-title holders** receive special attention under the Mission.



What Are the Key Provisions Related to Minor Forest Produce (MFP)?

- **Definition of MFP:** Under the **Forest Rights Act (FRA), 2006**, Minor Forest Produce includes non-timber forest products such as **bamboo, cane, tussar cocoons, honey, wax, lac, tendu leaves, mahua flowers, tamarind, medicinal plants, roots, tubers and wild herbs**.
- **Forest Rights:** The **FRA** recognises the dependence of forest-dwelling communities on forest produce and gives tribals rights to procure and sell non-timber Minor Forest Produce.
- **PESA Provision:** The **Panchayats (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996 (PESA)** grants **tribal Gram Panchayats ownership rights over Minor Forest Produce**.
- **MSP Support:** The government has notified **Minimum Support Price (MSP) for 87 MFP items under PMJVM**, helping protect tribal gatherers from distress sales.
- **Role of TRIFED:** **TRIFED purchases non-timber forest produce at the predetermined MSP** through State implementing agencies, including tribal development cooperatives and forest development corporations.
- **Procurement Performance:** Since **2013-14**, State governments have procured about **2.68 lakh metric tonnes of MFP worth ₹693.98 crore** under the scheme.
- **Livelihood Importance:** For millions of forest-dwelling tribal families, MFP is a **critical source of subsistence and cash income**. Many among India's **Scheduled Tribe population of around 10.4 crore** derive about **20-40% of their annual income** from MFP.
- **Issues:** Tribal gatherers often sell MFP to **middlemen at low prices**, receiving only a fraction of its market value and, in some cases, returns below the value of their labour.



How Does PMJVM Support Tribal Communities?

- **Van Dhan Vikas Kendras (VDVKs):** Tribal gatherers are organised into **SHGs** and clustered into **VDVKs** , with around **300 members per Kendra** and at least **60% Scheduled Tribe representation** .
- **Van Dhan Yojana:** Launched on **14th April 2018** , it forms the operational foundation of the VDVK model under PMJVM.
- **Skilling and Technology Support:** VDVKs provide training in **scientific harvesting, sustainable collection, value addition and primary processing** , along with tools, equipment and packaging support.
- **Financial and Infrastructure Support:** Tribal groups receive assistance for **working capital, storage, transportation and processing infrastructure** , including linkages with banks and **NSTFDC** .
- **Marketing Support:** VDVKs are linked with **Haat Bazaars, and private/non-profit partners** for marketing and value addition. TRIFED provides **market intelligence, including daily rates and e-commerce avenues**, while PMJVM supports branding, promotion, exhibitions and IT/e-commerce platforms.
- **Performance:** As of **31st July 2026** , **4,172 VDVKs had been sanctioned** , of which **2,911 were functional** , linking **12.48 lakh tribal members** and recording sales of around **₹168 crore** .

VDVKs Role in Tribal Women Empowerment

- **Women-Led Livelihoods:** Women undertake a major share of **MFP collection and sales** , making VDVKs an important instrument of tribal women's economic empowerment.
- **Value Addition:** VDVKs enable women to convert local forest and agricultural produce into **processed, marketable products** such as pickles, powders, jams and squashes.
- **Case Study:** The **Nyigamane, Ho Yorbe, Medumhagdum VDVK** in Leparada district of **Arunachal Pradesh** was established in **October 2021 with 300 women SHG members and farmers** .
- **Income Diversification:** The VDVK has generated sales of around **₹11 lakh since 2022-23** , reducing women's dependence on seasonal agriculture.
- **Entrepreneurial Ownership:** Women are not merely workers but **joint owners of the enterprise** , giving them a direct stake in production, branding and income generation.

Conclusion

Pradhan Mantri Janjatiya Vikas Mission is transforming India's tribal forest economy by combining MSP protection, value addition, skilling, community enterprise and market access. Through Van Dhan Vikas Kendras, tribal gatherers are being organised as producers, processors and entrepreneurs. By promoting natural, sustainable and locally rooted products, PMJVM contributes to tribal empowerment, women's financial inclusion and the vision of **Viksit Bharat@2047** .

Drishti Mains Question

Minor Forest Produce can become a major driver of tribal livelihoods and community-owned enterprises. Discuss.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is Pradhan Mantri Janjatiya Vikas Mission?

PMJVM is a scheme that supports tribal livelihoods by organising tribal gatherers into Van Dhan Vikas Kendras and promoting value addition, MSP procurement and market access for Minor Forest Produce.

2. What is Minor Forest Produce?

Minor Forest Produce refers to non-timber forest produce of plant origin such as honey, lac, tendu leaves, bamboo, medicinal plants, roots and tubers.

3. What is a Van Dhan Vikas Kendra?

A VDVK is a community-owned enterprise cluster formed by grouping tribal SHGs for value addition, processing and marketing of forest produce.

4. How many VDVKs have been sanctioned under PMJVM?

A total of **4,172 VDVKs** have been sanctioned.

5. What is the role of TRIFED?

TRIFED supports marketing and development of tribal products and purchases non-timber forest produce at the notified Minimum Support Price through State Implementing Agencies.

6. How does PMJVM empower tribal women?

PMJVM organises women collectors into SHGs and VDVKs, enabling them to process, brand and sell value-added products as community enterprise owners.

[Watch Video on YouTube:

▶ <https://www.youtube.com/embed/ANlbs05P-d0>

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UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims :

Q.1 Consider the following pairs: (2013)

Tribes	State
---------------	--------------

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--|
| 1. Limboo (Limbu) - Sikkim | |
| 2. Karbi - Himachal Pradesh | |
| 3. Dongria Kondh - Odisha | |
| 4. Bonda - Tamil Nadu | |

Which of the above pairs are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 2 and 4 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only
- (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans: (a)

Q.2 Consider the following statements about Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) in India: (2019)

1. PVTGs reside in 18 States and one Union Territory.
2. A stagnant or declining population is one of the criteria for determining PVTG status.
3. There are 95 PVTGs officially notified in the country so far.
4. Irular and Konda Reddi tribes are included in the list of PVTGs.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3
- (b) 2, 3 and 4
- (c) 1, 2 and 4
- (d) 1, 3 and 4

Ans: (c)

Q3. Under the Scheduled Tribes and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act, 2006, who shall be the authority to initiate the process for determining the nature and extent of individual or community forest rights or both? (2013)

- (a) State Forest Department
- (b) District Collector/Deputy Commissioner
- (c) Tahsildar/Block Development Officer/Mandal Revenue Officer
- (d) Gram Sabha

Ans: (d)

Mains

Q. Analyse the perspectives of Isolation, Assimilation and Integration in understanding the trajectories of Indian Tribal Development. **(2023)**

India's Trade Agreements in Action



Source: PIB

Why in News?

The Government has highlighted India's growing use of **Free Trade Agreements**, showing early export gains, rising preferential **Certificate of Origin** issuance and wider product diversification across FTA partner markets.

How Are India's FTAs Expanding Export Opportunities and Global Market Access?

- **Expanding Trade Network:** Over the past decade, India has expanded its network of **Free Trade Agreements (FTAs)** across major global markets, reflecting its growing economic weight and deeper integration with the world economy.
- **Wider Export Opportunities:** Recent FTAs are opening new markets for Indian exporters, diversifying trade partnerships and creating opportunities across goods, services and investment.
- **Focus on Effective Utilisation:** India's strategy is increasingly centred on ensuring that negotiated market access translates into **higher export participation, investment flows and employment generation**.
- **Balanced Trade Approach:** While pursuing greater global market access, India continues to safeguard **domestic priorities and sensitive sectors** through calibrated trade commitments.
- **Record Export Performance:** In **FY 2025-26**, India's combined merchandise and services exports reached a record **USD 863.1 billion**, including **USD 441.8 billion in merchandise exports**.
- **Continued Export Momentum:** During **April-June 2026**, combined exports grew by **11.37%** over the corresponding period of the previous year.

India-UAE CEPA: Early Trade Gains

- **Implementation:** The **India-UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** came into force on **1st May 2022**, following negotiations completed in a record **88 days**.
- **Largest Individual FTA Export Market:** India exported merchandise worth **USD 37.36 billion** to the UAE in FY 2025-26, making it India's **largest individual export destination among FTA partners**.
- **Bilateral Trade Milestone:** India-UAE bilateral trade crossed **USD 100.06 billion in FY 2024-25**, recording **19.6% growth**. This milestone was achieved within three years of the agreement coming into force.
- **Future Target:** India and the UAE have set a target of increasing bilateral trade to **USD 200 billion by 2032**.

India-Australia ECTA: Expanding Trade Partnership

- **Implementation:** The **India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (ECTA)** came into force on **29th December 2022**, becoming India's first trade agreement with a developed economy in more than a decade.
- **Export Growth:** India's exports to Australia increased from around **USD 4 billion in FY 2020-21 to USD 7.28 billion in FY 2025-26**, registering growth of more than **80%**.
- **Duty-Free Access:** Australia initially provided zero-duty access across **98.3% of its tariff lines**, and from **2026, all Indian exports became eligible for zero-duty access**.
- **Towards a Broader CECA:** The ECTA is serving as the foundation for negotiations on a more comprehensive **India-Australia CECA**, covering goods, services, mobility, digital trade, rules of origin and emerging areas of cooperation.

INDIA'S GROWING TRADE AGREEMENT PARTNERSHIPS



Export Facilitation through Certificates of Origin

- **Preferential Certificate of Origin:** To claim concessional tariff benefits under an FTA, exporters generally need to establish the origin of their goods. A **preferential Certificate of Origin (CoO)** certifies compliance with prescribed rules of origin and enables eligible products to receive reduced or zero customs duties.
- **Growing Use of FTA Benefits:** The **UAE CEPA and Australia ECTA** have generated substantial origin certification since becoming operational in 2022, indicating strong utilisation of tariff concessions.
- **e-CoO 2.0:** The platform enables **end-to-end digital issuance of preferential and non-preferential CoOs**, integrating exporters, issuing agencies and chambers of commerce. Aadhaar-based electronic signatures and QR-code verification improve authentication and processing efficiency.
- **Simplified Origin Rules:** Newer FTAs are reducing documentation requirements. The **India-EFTA TEPA and India-UK CETA permit self-declaration of origin**, while the UK agreement also allows importer's knowledge and waives origin documentation for consignments below **£1,000**.
- **Facilitation under Australia ECTA:** The India-Australia ECTA permits **multiple qualifying products to be covered under a single CoO**, reducing procedural burden on exporters.
- **Trade Connect Support:** The **Trade Connect platform** helps exporters, particularly MSMEs, identify FTA opportunities through its Tariff Explorer, access tariff schedules, seek guidance and resolve CoO-related concerns.

How Are India's FTAs Connecting Indian Goods and Skills to Global Markets?

Expanded Market Access for Merchandise Goods

- **India-UK CETA:** Nearly **99% of Indian exports** can enter the UK market duty-free.
- **India-Oman CEPA:** Tariff concessions cover around **98% of Oman's tariff lines** , substantially widening market access for Indian goods.
- **India-EFTA TEPA:** Preferential access covers **92.2% of tariff lines** , representing about **99.6% of India's exports** to EFTA markets.
- **India-Mauritius CECPA:** The agreement provides preferential market access for **310 Indian product lines** .
- **India-UAE CEPA:** Preferential access covers around **97% of UAE tariff lines** , accounting for nearly **99% of Indian exports** to the UAE.
- **India-Australia ECTA:** Indian exports receive **duty-free access across 100% of Australian tariff lines** .
- **Agreements Awaiting Implementation:** The **India-EU FTA** envisages preferential treatment across around **97% of EU tariff lines** , covering nearly **99.5% of bilateral trade value** , while the **India-New Zealand FTA** provides for duty-free access for **100% of Indian exports** from its entry into force.
- **Support to Labour-Intensive Sectors:** Wider market access particularly benefits **textiles, agriculture and processed food, leather and footwear, marine products, gems and jewellery, carpets and handicrafts** , enabling MSMEs, smaller producers and local enterprises to participate more actively in global trade.
- **Protection of Sensitive Sectors:** Calibrated tariff liberalisation and transition arrangements help preserve policy space for **farmers and sensitive domestic industries** .

New Opportunities for Indian Services and Professionals

- **Growing Importance of Services:** Services account for nearly **30% of India's employment** , while services exports reached around **USD 421.3 billion in FY 2025-26** , making services and professional mobility an important component of India's FTA strategy.
- **India-New Zealand FTA:** It provides a pathway for up to **5,000 skilled Indians to stay for up to three years** in sectors such as IT, engineering, healthcare, education, construction, AYUSH, yoga, culinary arts and music. It also includes commitments across **118 services sectors** and MFN treatment across **139 sectors** .
- **India-EU FTA:** Commitments cover **144 services sub-sectors** , including IT/ITeS, professional and business services, education, finance, tourism and construction. It also facilitates mobility of business visitors and intra-corporate transferees, provides work rights for dependants, and creates a framework for social-security cooperation and student mobility.
- **India-UK CETA:** Mobility provisions facilitate entry of **business visitors, intra-corporate transferees, contractual suppliers and independent professionals** , particularly in IT, healthcare, finance and education. The associated **Double Contribution Convention** is expected to prevent dual social-security payments and generate savings exceeding **₹4,000 crore** .
- **India-EFTA TEPA:** Indian service providers receive enhanced access to **128 sub-sectors in Switzerland, 114 in Norway, 110 in Iceland and 107 in Liechtenstein** , covering areas such as IT, business, professional, education, media and cultural services. It also provides for **Mutual Recognition Agreements (MRAs)** in nursing, chartered accountancy and architecture.
- **India-Oman CEPA:** It facilitates the temporary entry and stay of **intra-corporate transferees, contractual suppliers, business visitors and independent professionals** .
- **India-Australia ECTA:** Australia has made commitments across around **135 services sub-sectors** and extended MFN treatment across **120 sub-sectors** , including IT, business services, healthcare, education and audio-visual services.

- **India-UAE CEPA:** Indian service providers receive access to around **111 sub-sectors across 11 broad areas**, including business, communication, construction, education, finance, health, tourism and transport.
- **India-Mauritius CECPA:** The agreement provides access to around **115 services sub-sectors across 11 broad areas**, including professional, computer, telecommunications, financial, education, tourism, transport, audio-visual and yoga services.

Conclusion

India's FTA journey is moving from signing agreements to making them work for exporters, MSMEs, professionals and service providers. Recent agreements with the UAE, Australia, EFTA, Oman, the UK and others are expanding market access, while early export gains and increasing product diversification demonstrate the growing utilisation of FTA opportunities.

Drishti Mains Question

India's Free Trade Agreement strategy is shifting from market access creation to effective utilisation. Discuss.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. What is a Free Trade Agreement?

A Free Trade Agreement is an arrangement between countries to reduce or eliminate trade barriers such as customs duties on goods and services.

2. What is a Certificate of Origin?

A Certificate of Origin confirms that goods meet the prescribed rules of origin and are eligible for preferential tariff benefits under an FTA.

3. What is e-CoO 2.0?

e-CoO 2.0 is a digital system for end-to-end issuance of preferential and non-preferential Certificates of Origin.

4. What is India-UAE CEPA?

It is a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement between India and the UAE that came into force on **1st May 2022**.

5. What is India-Australia ECTA?

It is an Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement between India and Australia that came into force on **29th December 2022**.

6. What is MFN treatment?

Most-Favoured-Nation treatment means treating all trading partners equally under agreed trade commitments.

[Watch Video on YouTube: [▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/qegxEuMOKLI](https://www.youtube.com/embed/qegxEuMOKLI)]

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Questions (PYQs)

Prelims

Q. Consider the following countries: (2018)

1. Australia
2. Canada
3. China
4. India
5. Japan
6. USA

Which of the above are among the 'free-trade partners' of ASEAN?

- (a) 1, 2, 4 and 5
- (b) 3, 4, 5 and 6
- (c) 1, 3, 4 and 5
- (d) 2, 3, 4 and 6

Ans: (c)

Q. The term 'Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership' often appears in the news in the context of the affairs of a group of countries known as (2016)

- (a) G20
- (b) ASEAN
- (c) SCO
- (d) SAARC

Ans: (b)

Mains

Q. How would the recent phenomena of protectionism and currency manipulations in world trade affect macroeconomic stability of India? (2018)

India-Japan Maritime Security Pact



Source: TH

Why in News?

Recently, India and Japan signed a **Memorandum of Arrangement (MoA) on Maritime Security Cooperation** during bilateral talks between their Defence Ministers in New Delhi, aimed at **deepening defence and maritime security cooperation** .

How Are India and Japan Deepening Defence and Maritime Security Cooperation?

- **About the MoA:** The agreement provides a framework for closer cooperation between the **Indian Navy** and the **Japan Maritime Self-Defense Force (JMSDF)** , including **Maritime Domain Awareness (MDA)**, **Search and Rescue (SAR)**, and **Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR)** .
- **Sea Lines of Communication:** Both sides agreed to strengthen protection of **Sea Lines of Communication (SLOCs)** through reciprocal naval visits, joint exercises, personnel and expert exchanges, port access, logistics support, and maintenance and repair facilities.
- **Naval Shipbuilding and Repair:** India and Japan will explore **joint development in naval shipbuilding and design** , combining Japan's technological expertise with India's production capabilities, while also advancing **reciprocal ship-repair arrangements** and greater use of Indian shipyards under **Make in India** .
- **Military Exercises:** The two countries will expand exercises such as **Dharma Guardian** and **JAIMEX** , while the planned **Veer Guardian 26** will see Japanese fighter aircraft participate in an air exercise in India for the first time. They also plan more complex, short-notice and unmanned-system-enabled drills.
- **Defence Technology Cooperation:** India's **DRDO** and Japan's **Acquisition, Technology & Logistics Agency (ATLA)** will deepen cooperation in advanced defence technologies, while a **Defence Industry Forum** will promote industrial collaboration.
- **UNICORN Project:** The shipborne **UNICORN integrated communications antenna system** was identified as a key symbol of bilateral defence-equipment cooperation and is being pursued as the **first defence equipment transfer project between India and Japan** .
- **Special Operations and Theatre Commands:** Both sides agreed to promote exchanges between their **Special Operations Forces** and explore cooperation with India's **integrated theatre commands** after their establishment.
- **Indo-Pacific Cooperation:** India and Japan reaffirmed support for a **free and open Indo-Pacific** , opposed unilateral actions that threaten freedom of navigation or seek to alter the status quo by force, and agreed to deepen cooperation with third countries through exercises and initiatives such as the **Indo-Pacific Logistics Network** .
- **Institutional Mechanism:** A **Director-General/Joint Secretary-level Working Group** will coordinate cooperation across operational, intelligence, equipment, technology and industrial domains, while both sides will accelerate preparations for the **fourth India-Japan 2+2 Foreign and Defence Ministerial Dialogue in Tokyo** .

Read More: [16th India-Japan Annual Summit 2026](#)

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. Which maritime cooperation agreement was signed by India and Japan on 20 August 2026?
India and Japan signed a **Memorandum of Arrangement (MoA) on Maritime Security Cooperation** .

2. What areas are covered under the maritime security arrangement?

It covers Maritime Domain Awareness, information sharing, Search and Rescue, Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief, logistics support and SLOC protection.

3. What is JAIMEX?

JAIMEX is the Japan-India Maritime Exercise aimed at strengthening naval cooperation.

4. What is UNICORN in India-Japan defence cooperation?

UNICORN is a shipborne integrated communications antenna system and is identified as the first defence equipment transfer project between India and Japan.

5. What is the India-Japan 2+2 Dialogue?

It is a Foreign and Defence Ministerial Dialogue involving the foreign and defence ministers of both countries.

[Watch Video on YouTube:

▶ <https://www.youtube.com/embed/DyO-9nyyaps>

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UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Question (PYQ)

Prelims

Q1. In which one of the following groups are all four countries members of G20? (2020)

- (a) Argentina, Mexico, South Africa and Turkey
- (b) Australia, Canada, Malaysia and New Zealand
- (c) Brazil, Iran, Saudi Arabia and Vietnam
- (d) Indonesia, Japan, Singapore and South Korea

Ans: (a)

Q. Consider the following countries: (2018)

1. Australia
2. Canada
3. China
4. India
5. Japan
6. USA

Which of the above are among the 'free-trade partners' of ASEAN?

- (a) 1, 2, 4 and 5
- (b) 3, 4, 5 and 6
- (c) 1, 3, 4 and 5
- (d) 2, 3, 4 and 6

Ans: (c)

Mains

Q. Quadrilateral Security Dialogue (Quad) is transforming itself into a trade bloc from a military alliance, in present times Discuss. **(2020).**

Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme



Source: [TH](#)

Why in News?

Recently, the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** approved **31 additional proposals** under the **Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS)** involving fresh investment of **₹6,844 crore**.

- The latest approvals cover **electrolyte additives, hermetic terminals for defence-grade sealed assemblies, metalised films for capacitors, and coils**, all of which are being manufactured in India for the first time.

What are the Key Facts About Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme?

- **ECMS:** Launched in April 2025 by the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)**, it aims to build a **self-sustaining electronics component ecosystem** by attracting domestic and global investment across the value chain by integrating its domestic electronic industry with the **Global Value Chains (GVCs)**.
- **Incentive Structure:** The ECMS provides **turnover-linked, capex-linked, or hybrid fiscal incentives**, with a portion of both turnover and capex incentives linked to employment generation.
 - Incentives will be given on a **first-come, first-served basis** to firms ready for early production.
- **Tenure:** ECMS has a **six-year tenure** with a one-year gestation period for the Turnover Linked Incentive, while the Capex Incentive is available for a five-year period.
- **Target Segments:** It focuses on **sub-assemblies** such as camera modules and display units, **bare components** including multi-layer PCBs, capacitors, and resistors, and **capital equipment** used in electronics factories, together accounting for **nearly 90% of the Bill of Materials (BoM)** for mobile phones.
- **Surplus Investment Interest:** As of December 2025, the ECMS attracted **Rs 1.15 lakh crore in investment commitments**, which is **double the initial target of Rs 59,350 crore**.
- **Projected Economic Outcomes:** ECMS is expected to generate **Rs 10.34 lakh crore over six years** and create **1.41 lakh direct jobs** and several lakh indirect opportunities.
 - Positions electronics as India's potential **second-largest export item**, following a **six-fold production increase** in the last decade.
- **Synergy with ISM 2.0:** The ECMS acts as a horizontal enabler, working alongside the **India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0** to build a comprehensive ecosystem covering materials, equipment, and advanced packaging.

Significance

- **Progress towards Self-Reliance:** India has achieved self-reliance in enclosures, relays, anode material and optical transceivers, while domestic production meets around 80% of demand for laminates, 75% for connectors, 60% for lithium-ion cells and 55% for transducers.
- **Geographical Spread:** Projects in the latest tranche cover **10 States** —Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Gujarat, Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Telangana. **Tamil Nadu leads with 7 project approvals**, the highest among the States.
- **Expected Output and Jobs:** The newly approved projects are expected to generate around **₹82,243 crore in production** and create employment for nearly **10,000 people**.

Supporting Policy Framework

- **Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme:** It covers 14 sectors and nearly **70% of the USD 4 billion FDI in electronics** since 2020 is attributed to **PLI beneficiaries**.
 - The sector has also benefited from allowing **100% foreign direct investment in electronics manufacturing**, subject to applicable laws and regulations.
- **Modified Electronics Manufacturing Clusters (EMC 2.0) Scheme:** Focuses on creating world-class infrastructure through **Modified Electronics Manufacturing Clusters** .
- **Scheme for Promotion of Manufacturing of Electronic Components and Semiconductors (SPECS):** Provides a **25% financial incentive on capital expenditure** for high-value electronic components.
- **National Policy on Electronics (NPE) 2019:** The overarching **National Policy on Electronics** aiming to position India as a global hub for Electronics System Design and Manufacturing (ESDM).
- **Fiscal Incentives:** The Union Budget 2026-27, announced **Basic Customs Duty (BCD) exemptions** for microwave oven inputs and **Social Welfare Surcharge exemptions** for electronic toy parts.

Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is the Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme?

ECMS is a government scheme aimed at developing domestic manufacturing capacity for electronic components, sub-assemblies, supply-chain materials and capital equipment.

2. Which ministry implements ECMS?

It is implemented by the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology** .

3. What is the tenure of ECMS?

The scheme has a **six-year tenure with a one-year gestation period** .

4. What types of incentives are offered under ECMS?

ECMS provides Turnover-linked incentives, Capital expenditure-linked incentives and Hybrid incentives combining both.

[Watch Video on YouTube: [▶ https://www.youtube.com/embed/qnyu37kPeWE](https://www.youtube.com/embed/qnyu37kPeWE)]

UPSC Civil Services Examination, Previous Year Questions

Prelims

Q. 'R2 Code of Practices' constitutes a tool available for promoting the adoption of (2020)

- (a) environmentally responsible practices in electronics recycling industry
- (b) ecological management of Wetlands of International Importance under the Ramsar Convention
- (c) sustainable practices in the cultivation of agricultural crops in degraded lands
- (d) 'Environmental Impact Assessment' in the exploitation of natural resources

Ans: (a)

Mains

Q. Faster economic growth requires increased share of the manufacturing sector in GDP, particularly of MSMEs. Comment on the present policies of the Government in this regard. [2023]

Q. "Success of Make in India programme depends on the success of Skill India programme and radical labour reforms." Discuss with logical arguments. [2015]

MH-60R Seahawk Helicopter



Source: TH

The Indian Navy has received another **MH-60R Seahawk helicopter** from the **United States**, bringing deliveries to 21 of the 24 helicopters ordered.

MH-60R Seahawk Helicopter

- **About:** The MH-60R Seahawk, also known as the “**Romeo**”, is an all-weather, **shipborne multi-role naval helicopter** manufactured by Lockheed Martin.
- **Primary Role:** It is designed mainly for **Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW)** and **Anti-Surface Warfare (ASuW)**, significantly enhancing the Navy’s maritime surveillance and combat capabilities.
- **Advanced Sensors:** The helicopter is equipped with **multi-mode radar, dipping sonar, sonobuoys, electro-optical/infrared sensors, electronic-support measures, datalinks** and aircraft-survivability systems, enabling detection and tracking of surface and underwater threats.
- **Weapons Capability:** Its weapons include **Mk-54 lightweight torpedoes, AGM-114 Hellfire air-to-ground missiles**, rockets and crew-served machine guns, allowing it to engage both submarines and surface targets.
- **Multi-Mission Capability:** Besides combat operations, the **MH-60R can undertake search and rescue, medical evacuation, surveillance and logistics-support missions**, expanding the operational reach of Indian warships.
- **India’s Procurement:** India signed a deal with the US in 2020 to procure **24 MH-60Rs** to replace its ageing **Sea King fleet**. The Navy commissioned **INAS 334 ‘Seahawks’ at Kochi in March 2024** and later raised **INAS 335 ‘Ospreys’ at Goa** in December 2025.
 - India has also signed a **five-year sustainment-support package** for the fleet under the **US Foreign Military Sales (FMS) programme**.
- **Significance:** The helicopters strengthen India’s **anti-submarine warfare**, **maritime-domain awareness and shipborne aviation capability**, while deepening defence cooperation with the United States.

Read more: [India’s Maritime Strategy](#)

Hara Mangrove Forests



Source: TH

The Hara mangrove forests of **Iran’s Qeshm Island** are facing a serious environmental threat after **oil residues reached the island and parts of the protected mangrove ecosystem** , amid continuing conflict and shipping-related oil spills in the **Persian Gulf**.

Hara Forests

- **Location:** Located around **Qeshm Island and the Khuran Strait near the Strait of Hormuz** , the Hara forests are among the largest and most ecologically important mangrove ecosystems along the Persian Gulf.
- **Flora and Salinity Adaptation:** The forests are dominated by the **grey mangrove (Avicennia marina)** , whose specialised root system helps it filter salt and survive in highly saline coastal waters.
- **Biodiversity Hotspot:** The forests serve as **breeding, nursery and feeding grounds for fish, shrimp, crabs and other marine species** , while also supporting migratory birds, marine mammals and **critically endangered hawksbill sea turtles**.
- **UNESCO Status:** The Hara forests form part of the **UNESCO -designated Hara Biosphere Reserve** , reflecting their ecological significance, while Qeshm is also recognised for its globally important geological and ecological heritage.
- **Importance:** Local **fishing communities depend heavily on the surrounding marine ecosystem**, while the mangrove waterways are also central to Qeshm’s sustainable tourism, supporting boat tours and nature-based livelihoods.

Read More: [Qeshm Island](#)